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AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Subaru | Model: Forester | Australian Market Years: 1997-Present
Vehicle Type: Compact / Medium SUV | Segment: Medium SUV | Locally Built: No
Assembly Plants (AU):

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Subaru Forester is an Australian automotive legend that helped pioneer the compact all-whee
l-drive crossover genre in 1997. Blending permanent Symmetrical All-Wheel Drive, high ground cl
earance, commanding estate-car visibility, and turbocharged WRX engines in GT and XT badges, it
earned an intensely loyal following among Australian families, campers, and rural motorists.

Launched in Australia in September 1997, the Forester was an instant sales success. The introdu
ction of the turbo Forester GT in 1998 democratized high-performance all-weather motoring for f
amilies, a formula expanded with the SG XT, SH S-Edition, and SJ XT. Across six generations, th
e Forester has been a fixture of Australian outdoor lifestyle culture.

SERIES / GENERATION: SF (Forester 1st Generation (inc. GT Turbo)) [1997-2002]

Body Styles: 5-door Wagon / SUV | ANCAP: 3 stars
Pioneered the crossover wagon formula in Australia. The naturally aspirated 2.0L EJ20 was joine
d in late 1998 by the cult hero Forester GT Turbo (125kW EJ205 with WRX genetics).

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EJ20J / EJ202: 2.0L (1994cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 92.0 kW /
- EJ205-SF: 2.0L (1994cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Turbocharged Intercooled, Premium Unleaded Pet

Australian Badges / Trims:

- GX / Limited: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD (dual-range on manual), Trans=5-speed dual-range manual, 4-s
- GT Turbo: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with rear LSD, Trans=5-speed manual, 4-speed automatic, AUD $379

Factory Configurations:

* Forester GT Turbo Manual | 5-door Wagon | EJ205-SF | 5-speed manual | AWD | 125.0kW/240.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: SG (Forester 2nd Generation (inc. XT Turbo)) [2002-2008]

Body Styles: 5-door Wagon / SUV | ANCAP: 5 stars (facelift)
Crisper styling, hydroformed front subframe, 5-star ANCAP safety, and the legendary 2.5L EJ255
XT Turbo delivering up to 169kW with WRX acceleration.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- EJ251 / EJ253: 2.5L (2457cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 121.0 kW /
- EJ255-SG: 2.5L (2457cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Turbocharged Intercooled, Premium Unleaded Pet

Australian Badges / Trims:

- X / XS: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD (dual-range on manual), Trans=5-speed manual with dual-range, 4-sp
- XT Turbo: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with rear LSD, Trans=5-speed manual, 4-speed automatic, AUD $399

Factory Configurations:

* Forester XT 2.5 Turbo Manual | 5-door Wagon | EJ255-SG | 5-speed manual | AWD | 169.0kW/320.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: SH (Forester 3rd Generation (inc. S-Edition)) [2008-2013]

Body Styles: 5-door SUV | ANCAP: 5 stars
Full transition to true medium SUV dimensions with double-wishbone rear suspension, 2.0L Boxer
Diesel, and the sensational 193kW Forester S-Edition with WRX STI hardware.

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Engines Offered in Australia:

- FB25: 2.5L (2498cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 126.0 kW / 235.0 Nm
- EJ255-SE: 2.5L (2457cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Turbocharged Intercooled (STI Turbo), Premium

Australian Badges / Trims:

- X / XS: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD, Trans=5-speed manual with dual-range, 4-speed auto, AUD $30490-$3
- S-Edition: Drivetrain=Variable Torque Distribution (VTD) AWD, Trans=5-speed sports automatic with pad

Factory Configurations:

* Forester S-Edition Turbo Auto | 5-door SUV | EJ255-SE | 5-speed automatic | AWD | 193.0kW/347.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: SJ (Forester 4th Generation (inc. XT DIT)) [2013-2018]

Body Styles: 5-door SUV | ANCAP: 5 stars

Introduced EyeSight driver assist stereo cameras, X-Mode off-road traction control, and the dir
ect-injection turbo 2.0L FA20DIT in the XT (177kW/350Nm).

Engines Offered in Australia:

- FA20DIT: 2.0L (1998cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Twin-Scroll Turbocharged Intercooled, Premium U

Australian Badges / Trims:

- 2.5i-L / 2.5i-S: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with X-Mode, Trans=6-speed manual, Lineartronic CVT, AUD
- 2.0XT / XT Premium: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with SI-Drive, Trans=Lineartronic CVT with 8-speed man

Factory Configurations:

* Forester 2.0XT Premium | 5-door SUV | FA20DIT | Lineartronic CVT | AWD | 177.0kW/350.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: SK (Forester 5th Generation & Hybrid) [2018-2024]

Body Styles: 5-door SUV | ANCAP: 5 stars

Built on the rigid Subaru Global Platform. Features Driver Monitoring System with facial recogn
ition, standard EyeSight, direct-injection 2.5L engine, and e-Boxer Hybrid.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- FB25D: 2.5L (2498cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 136.0 kW / 239.0 N

Australian Badges / Trims:

- 2.5i-L / 2.5i-Premium / 2.5i-S: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with Dual-Function X-Mode, Trans=Lineartro

Factory Configurations:

* Forester 2.5i-S AWD | 5-door SUV | FB25D | Lineartronic CVT | AWD | 136.0kW/239.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: SL (Forester 6th Generation) [2025-Present]

Body Styles: 5-door SUV | ANCAP: 5 stars (expected)

Next-generation model featuring 10% stiffer chassis, full-inner-frame construction, portrait 11
.6-inch infotainment, wide-angle mono camera EyeSight, and refined 2.5L boxer.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- FB25-SL: 2.5L (2498cc) Horizontally Opposed Boxer-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 134.0 kW / 241.0

Australian Badges / Trims:

- 2.5i / 2.5i-L / Sport / Touring: Drivetrain=Symmetrical AWD with Dual-Function X-Mode, Trans=Lineartr

Factory Configurations:

* Forester Touring AWD | 5-door SUV | FB25-SL | Lineartronic CVT | AWD | 134.0kW/241.0Nm